

Preliminary Research Reflection (07/26)

To begin my literature review, I started to familiarize myself with key institutions and industries that deal with aging using technology. Primarily, I looked into medical institutions that focus on geriatrics, and found many potential articles on how older adults interact with technology, and how they feel about the current tech landscape. Moreover, I looked into popular sources of writing about aging, like AARP, and found some avenues of interest into technology use for older adults, and common issues. The most important of these I feel is the issue of elder fraud and the common practice of spam and scam directed towards older adults, and their catastrophic effects it has on families. Finally, I introduced myself to the types of existing products for older adults that focus on assistive functionality. Despite all of the devices having different functionalities, whether acting as smart-home services, health-tracking “smart” watches, or adapted phones and tablets for decreased hand-motor control, they all shared one key aspect—subscription. For these targeted products, something as simple as an automatic pill dispenser had a \$30 dollar monthly subscription (see the [Hero Smart Pill Dispenser](#)). This is something that I feel is incredibly predatory, and I strongly believe that these products should be cheap and available without needing to be subscribed to (subscriptions being something that younger people still struggle to manage properly).